

environment has more drawbacks than does self-sufficiency, even if that means accepting a less affluent lifestyle.

Mary is much like the daughter of the grandmother in our audience. Both have received economic outpatient care. The donors in both cases made the same assumption: Economic outpatient care will “get the youngsters going” and then won’t be needed anymore. Mary’s mother was wrong. She has been providing her special blend of outpatient care for more than twenty-five years. Her daughter’s family is economically dependent.

Lamar has also benefited from outpatient care. Shortly after he and his wife were married, Lamar quit his job to pursue a master’s degree. His own parents paid all his tuition and related expenses. This is not at all unusual. In fact, 32 percent of America’s millionaires pay for their adult children’s graduate school education.

The couple’s first child was born shortly after Lamar began his graduate studies. Mary’s mother did not like the apartment that the couple initially rented near the university Lamar attended. She took it upon herself to send a cleaning crew over regularly to “freshen the place up.” But in her mind this was not the ideal environment for her daughter’s family. So Mother offered to help the couple buy a home.

Lamar did help to make ends meet. He received a few hundred dollars each month from the university for his part-time job as a staff assistant. Mary did not work at that time. In fact, she has been a fulltime housewife throughout her marriage.

Mary’s mother placed a sizable down payment on the couple’s home. Nearly six in ten (59 percent) affluent parents who have adult children tell us that they have provided their children with “financial assistance in purchasing a home.” Mary’s mother also made the couple’s mortgage payments. Note that 17 percent of the millionaires we have interviewed indicated that they have made such payments (see [Table 5-1](#)). Initially, Mary’s mother was to provide these funds as an interest-free loan. But eventually the loan was converted to a more conventional type. Forgiveness loans are considered to be quite conventional among recipients of economic outpatient care. Sixty-one percent of America’s affluent have provided such “loans” to their adult children. What happened when the couple traded up to a more expensive home? Mary’s mother once again subsidized the purchase. Eventually the couple moved to their current residence. Once again, economic outpatient care was part of this purchase.